

ZHANIBEK DARIMBEK

Applied AI / Agent Engineer

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EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer — Sema *US (Remote)* Oct 2025 – Present

Tech lead on Liz, Sema's AI engineering-intelligence platform.

- Led the agent's migration off live customer APIs onto a governed data layer: an entity-anchored mirror queried through tenant-scoped, read-only SQL views.
- Measured the result end to end: cost per run down 52%, wall-clock time down 68%, score variance more than halved.
- Moved the agent onto Pydantic AI's Capabilities/Harness, replacing home-grown abstractions for context compaction, code mode, subagents and guardrails with maintained framework primitives.
- Replaced retrieval-based analysis of large tabular files with generated code in an isolated sandbox, so counts came from computed aggregates rather than sampled rows.
- Built repeatable trajectory-level evaluation over production agent runs, grading execution efficiency rather than answer quality alone. Found 86% of parallel tool batches stalled behind one slow call, and a headline "slow agent" metric that was 74% queue wait.
- Designed privacy guards across the full agent loop so engineering analytics stay at team level and cannot become individual surveillance.

Senior Software Engineer — Monite *Germany (Remote)* May 2024 – Oct 2025

- Built accounts-receivable, payments, and accounting-automation APIs for B2B fintech platforms.
- Shipped an AI feature for drafting AR invoices from natural language, using Pydantic AI with tool calling grounded in a company's invoice history; delivered as an API resource and a ready-to-issue PDF.
- Designed a PDF customization engine for AR documents, with dynamic templates, styling, and line-item configuration for partners' branding.
- Rebuilt the Recurring Invoices API with flexible scheduling (weekly, monthly, custom dates), draft/send via email, and pause, cancel, and resend flows.
- Stood up an internal MCP server that pulls context from Notion, Jira, Confluence, and GitHub into one space for coding agents, cutting context switching and ticket-to-deploy time.

CTO — ioka group *Almaty, Kazakhstan* Nov 2020 – May 2024

Founding engineer; grew to CTO of a fintech and travel ecosystem in Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan.

- Built the payment gateway from scratch and took it to 200+ merchants: talked directly to customers' developers, collected feedback, built custom solutions, and scaled with them.
- Shipped APIs and mobile SDKs for card acquiring, Apple Pay, Google Pay, BNPL, saved cards, subscriptions, P2P, payment links, and payouts.
- Built multi-acquirer orchestration with routing by availability, cost, and payment scheme.
- Led PCI DSS Level 1 certification: worked with QSA assessors, documented architecture and processes, ran scans, applied recommendations, and maintained compliance across quarterly and annual cycles.
- Built ioka Travel's backend with GDS and railway ticket provider integrations, deployed end to end to first customers in Uzbekistan.

Software Engineer — Kazdream Tech *Astana, Kazakhstan* May 2019 – Nov 2020

- Automated data collection from 20+ social networks, messaging platforms, and web/mobile sources; built crawlers integrated into scalable B2B APIs and real-time systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI / LLM: Multi-agent systems, tool/function calling, RAG & semantic retrieval (pgvector, embeddings), MCP servers, trajectory-level evals & guardrails; Pydantic AI, provider SDKs (OpenAI / Anthropic / Gemini), LangChain / LangGraph

Backend: Python (async), FastAPI, aiohttp, API design

Data: PostgreSQL (+ pgvector), Redis, RabbitMQ

Frontend & Tools: React, TypeScript, AI SDK, Docker

EDUCATION

M.Sc., Data Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2020 – 2022

Thesis: Sequential Deep Learning Models for Human Skeleton-based Gait Recognition

B.Sc., Computer Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2016 – 2020